

an attitude of great caution when dependence is alleged. The need of caution is the more obvious to us when we notice how far-reaching are the theories which have been built on the assumption of this dependence. It is perhaps as well to remember that these theories do not come from Iranian experts, but from scholars whose fame was achieved in other fields. Were we to count only the Iranists, we should even doubt whether the Parsi did not borrow from the Jew, for that was the view of Darmesteter! And it must be allowed that, however high is the authority of the protagonists in this controversy, they have nearly all come to the problem from another side, compelled to take much at second hand when dealing with Iranian texts. The real Avestan experts are very cautious indeed. From yet another point of view we learn the same lesson. Nothing impresses us more vividly, in prolonged reading of modern *religionsgeschichtlich* research, than the tenuity of the resemblances upon which historical connexion is often built up. Böklen's parallels are to a very large extent a conspicuous example in our particular field, though they are vitiated still more seriously by indifference to the date of his Parsi authorities, and to the existence—often naïvely admitted—of equally impressive parallels from other sources. The very thought of fortuitous coincidence seems hardly to enter the minds of many most learned and acute investigators.¹ The cautions of Prof. Clemen, in his

¹ I cannot resist quoting one extraordinary example touching the other side of the Aryan field. Dr Hugo Gressmann, in his most able and suggestive book on the origin of Jewish eschatology (p. 305), finds traces of mythus in the statement (Isai. 41⁸) that